🔭 AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Watchtower

Threat Intelligence Tools & Feeds

16	55,949	62%	10
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Intro: See what's coming — intel platforms, knowledge bases, ransomware trackers and exposure watchtowers.

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-17 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects and note who uses each tool and the commercial product it replaces; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — **444 curated free tools across 14 realms**.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
CC0 · 2026-10-17

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-17

16	10	55,949	10	3,083	2012
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Intro: See what's coming — intel platforms, knowledge bases, ransomware trackers and exposure watchtowers.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

The Watchtower threat intelligence tools realm hosts 16 curated tools, with 10 (62%) of those repositories on GitHub, all of which received code pushes in 2026 indicating active maintenance as of the latest data. Adoption in the realm is heavily concentrated among its top five tools, which account for 49,100 of the total 55,949 combined stars, with SpiderFoot alone holding 23.6k stars—nearly half of the total collective user engagement. The median star count of 3,083 confirms a clear gap between widely adopted flagship tools and smaller, less visible entries in the curated set. A notable takeaway is the dominance of Python as the primary language for these tools, with 5 of the 16 entries built on it, aligning with common preferences for flexible, rapid development in cybersecurity tooling.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

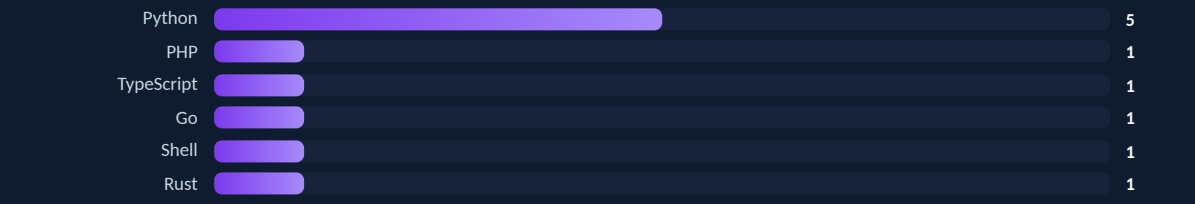
TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



LANGUAGE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES

SpiderFoot	2012-04-28
MISP	2013-02-07
IntelMQ	2014-06-24
firehol/blocklist-ipsets	2015-05-12
Yeti	2015-12-13

THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS

http-detection-agent	2026-09
RansomLook	2022-08
Uncover	2022-03
IntelOwl	2019-12
OpenCTI	2018-12

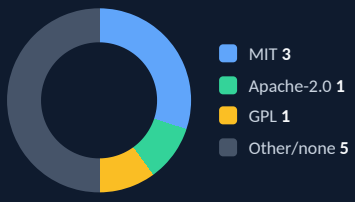
CREATION ERAS — WHEN THE REALM WAS BUILT

2008-2012	2013-2016	2017-2020	2021-2026
1	4	2	3

QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

none — every GitHub entry pushed in 2026

LICENSE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, **who uses it and which commercial product it replaces**, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

Profiles are ordered by GitHub adoption (stars). Non-GitHub entries follow, alphabetically. Flagship marks the realm's top 8 by stars.

01 SpiderFoot

github.com/smicallef/spiderfoot

★ FLAGSHIP PICK · ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 23.6k	GITHUB STARS
3,776	FORKS
2026-04	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"SpiderFoot automates OSINT for threat intelligence and mapping your attack surface."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open-source OSINT automation with 200+ data sources; attack-surface and exposure monitoring out of the box.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by OSINT investigators automating recon; the free self-hosted version of the SpiderFoot HX service.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	3,776	346	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

02 OpenCTI

github.com/OpenCTI-Platform/OpenCTI

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 10.2k	GITHUB STARS
1,479	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
TypeScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Open Cyber Threat Intelligence Platform"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

threat-intel knowledge graph built on STIX2; analyst-first investigation dashboards instead of raw feeds.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTI teams building knowledge graphs of threat data; the open-source alternative to commercial intel platforms with graph UIs.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8	1,479	2,200	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

03 MISP

github.com/MISP/MISP

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.6k	GITHUB STARS
1,653	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"MISP (core software) - Open Source Threat Intelligence and Sharing Platform"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the de-facto open threat-sharing platform: events, attributes, galaxies and thousands of community feeds.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CERTs and threat-intel teams worldwide; the leading open-source alternative to commercial threat-intelligence platforms like Recorded Future and ThreatQ.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



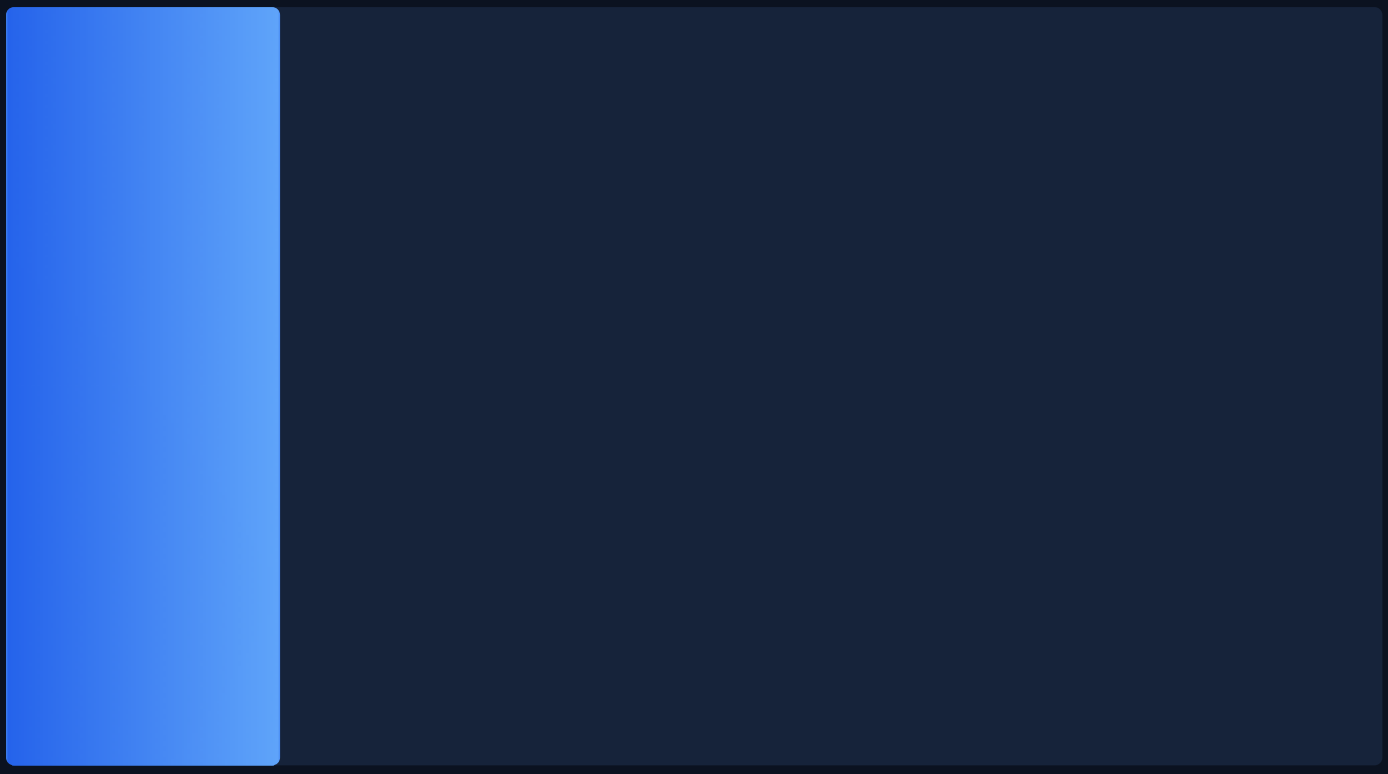
13	1,653	2,945	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

04 IntelOwl

github.com/intelowlproject/IntelOwl

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.8k	GITHUB STARS
692	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"IntelOwl: manage your Threat Intelligence at scale"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

bulk-analyze observables across 100+ online services from one API and web UI.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by SOC analysts enriching observables in bulk; the open-source alternative to commercial one-click threat-inquiry APIs.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



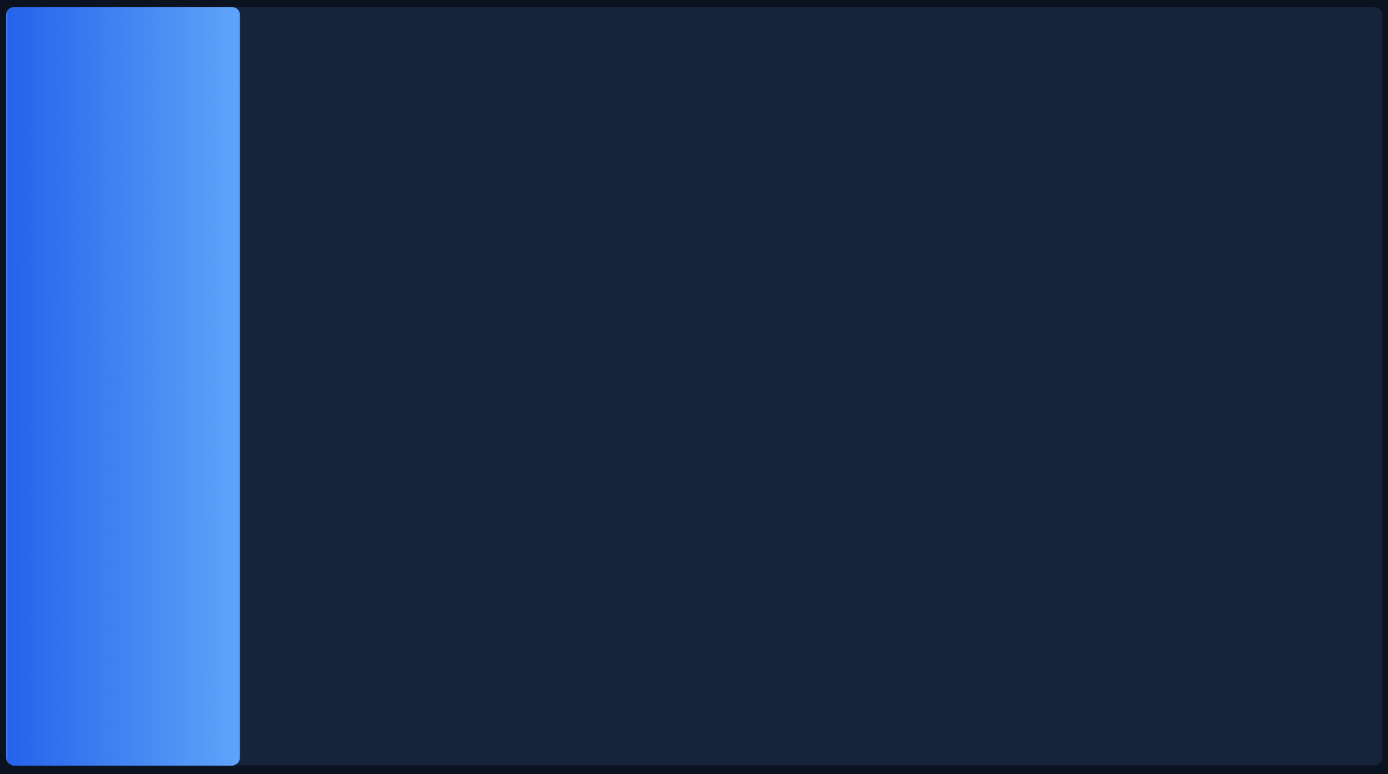
7	692	93	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

05 firehol/blocklist-ipsets

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

github.com/firehol/blocklist-ipsets

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.9k	GITHUB STARS
423	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
None	LICENSE
Shell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"ipsets dynamically updated with firehol's update-ipsets.sh script"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

aggregated, daily-updated IP blocklists (attacks, spam, abuse) ready for iptables/fail2ban; check each list's own license before redistribution.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by firewall admins feeding blocklists; the community-maintained alternative to commercial IP-reputation feeds.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



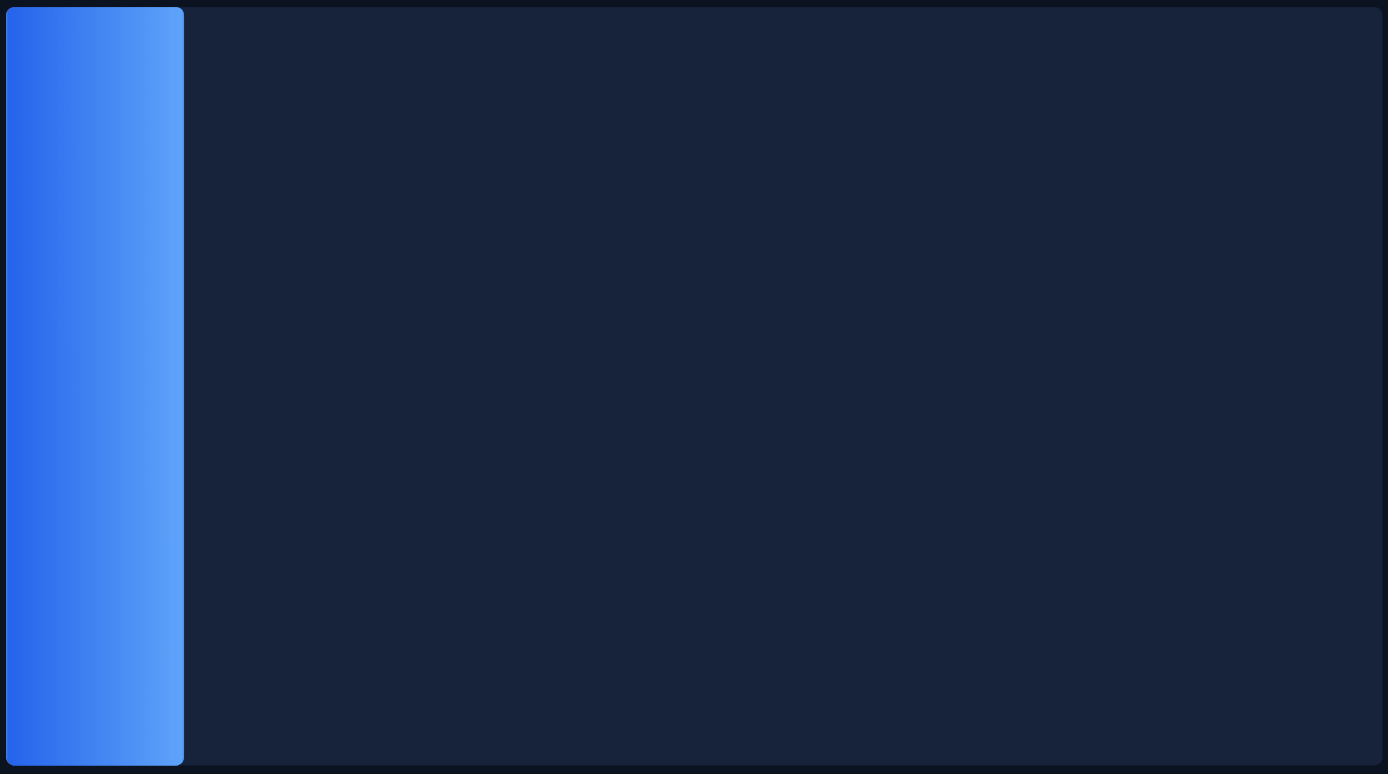
11	423	261	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

06 Uncover

github.com/projectdiscovery/uncover

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.1k	GITHUB STARS
280	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2022	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Quickly discover exposed hosts on the internet using multiple search engines."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

query exposed services across Shodan, Censys and friends in one sweep — the instant exposure check.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by recon teams querying exposure across search engines at once; the free aggregator for Shodan-style lookups.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



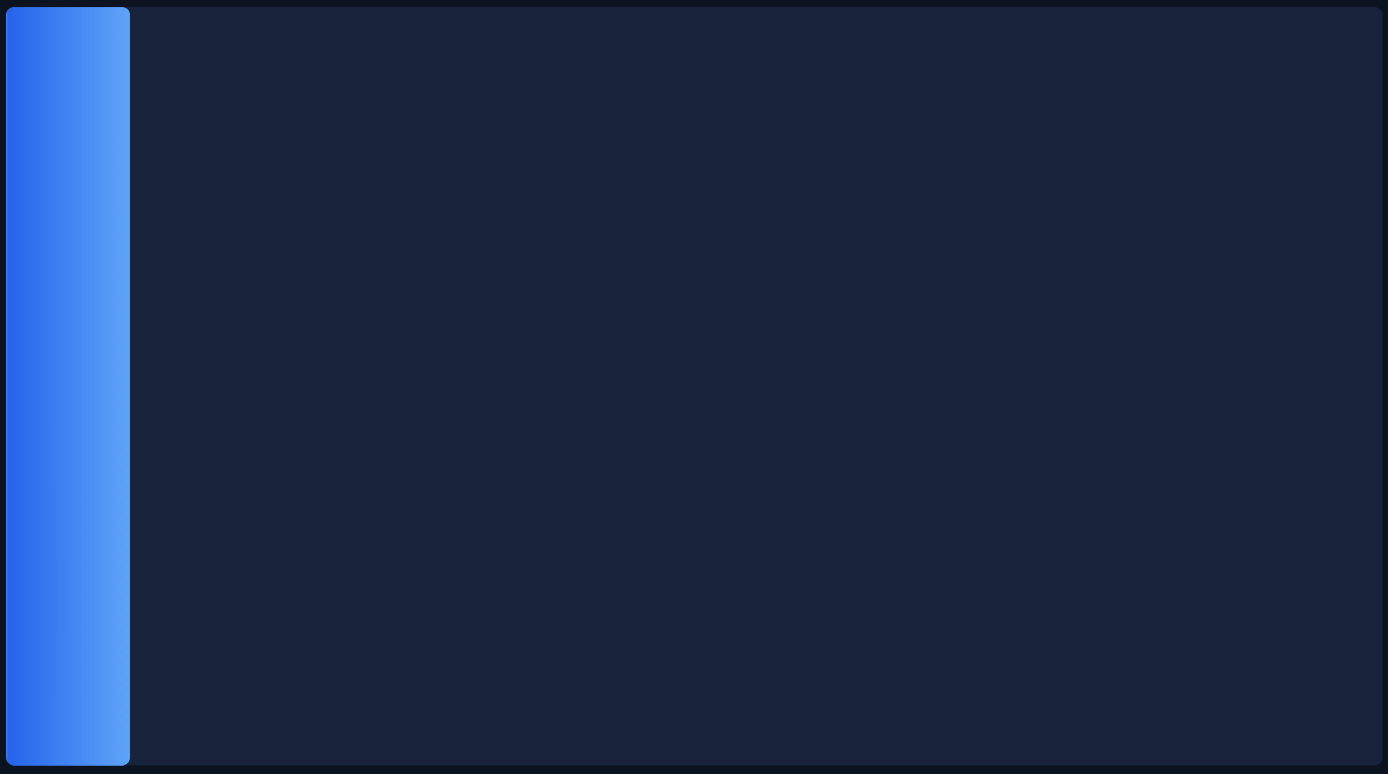
4	280	13	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

07 Yeti

github.com/yeti-platform/yeti

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2k	GITHUB STARS
324	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Your Everyday Threat Intelligence"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

organize your threat intel: observables, indicators and TTPs in one searchable, API-first platform.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTI analysts organizing indicators and TTPs; the open-source threat-intel tracker for teams without commercial TIP budgets.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



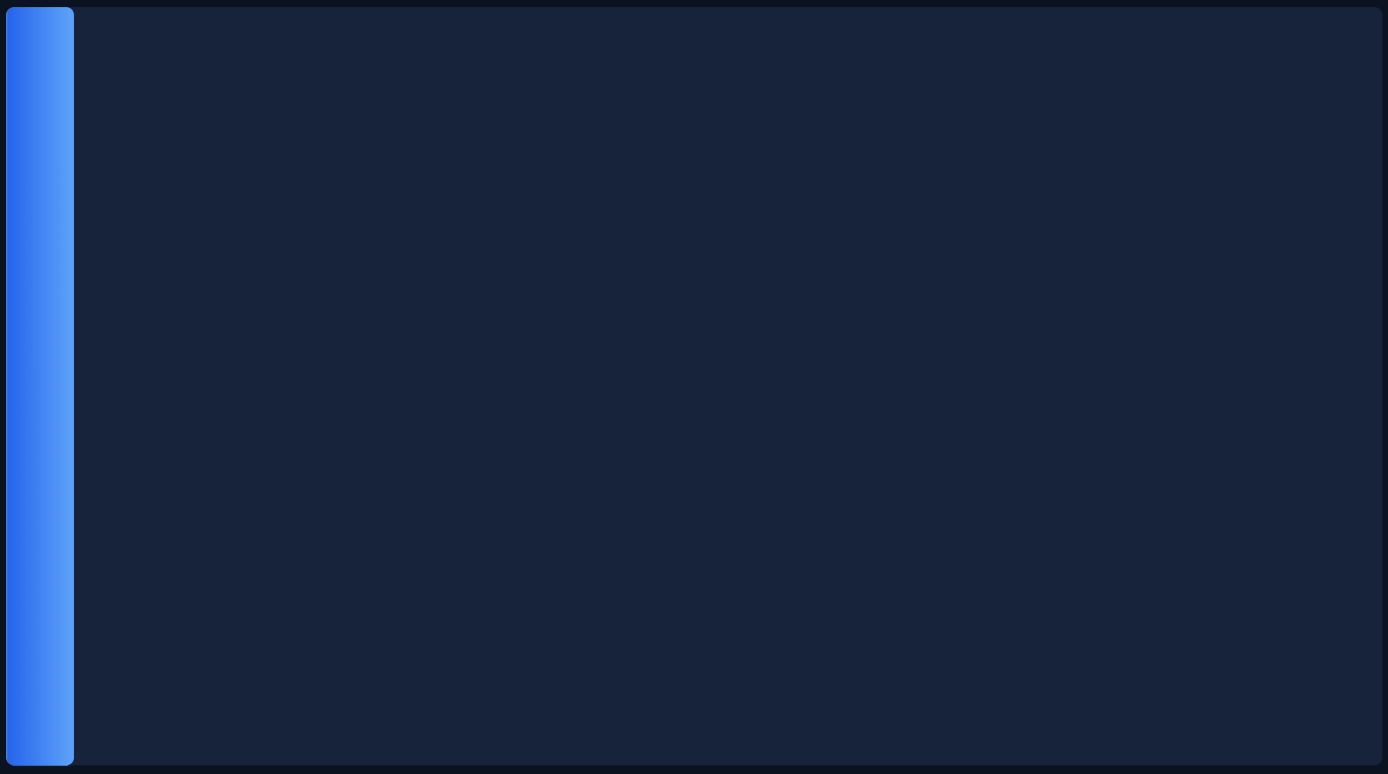
11	324	63	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

08 IntelMQ

github.com/certtools/intelmq

★ FLAGSHIP PICK · ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.1k	GITHUB STARS
319	FORKS
2026-04	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"IntelMQ is a solution for IT security teams for collecting and processing security feeds using a message queuing protocol."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the feed plumber's dream: collect, normalize and route threat-intel feeds from hundreds of sources into your stack.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by national CERTs automating feed ingestion; the open-source alternative to commercial intel-pipeline tooling.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



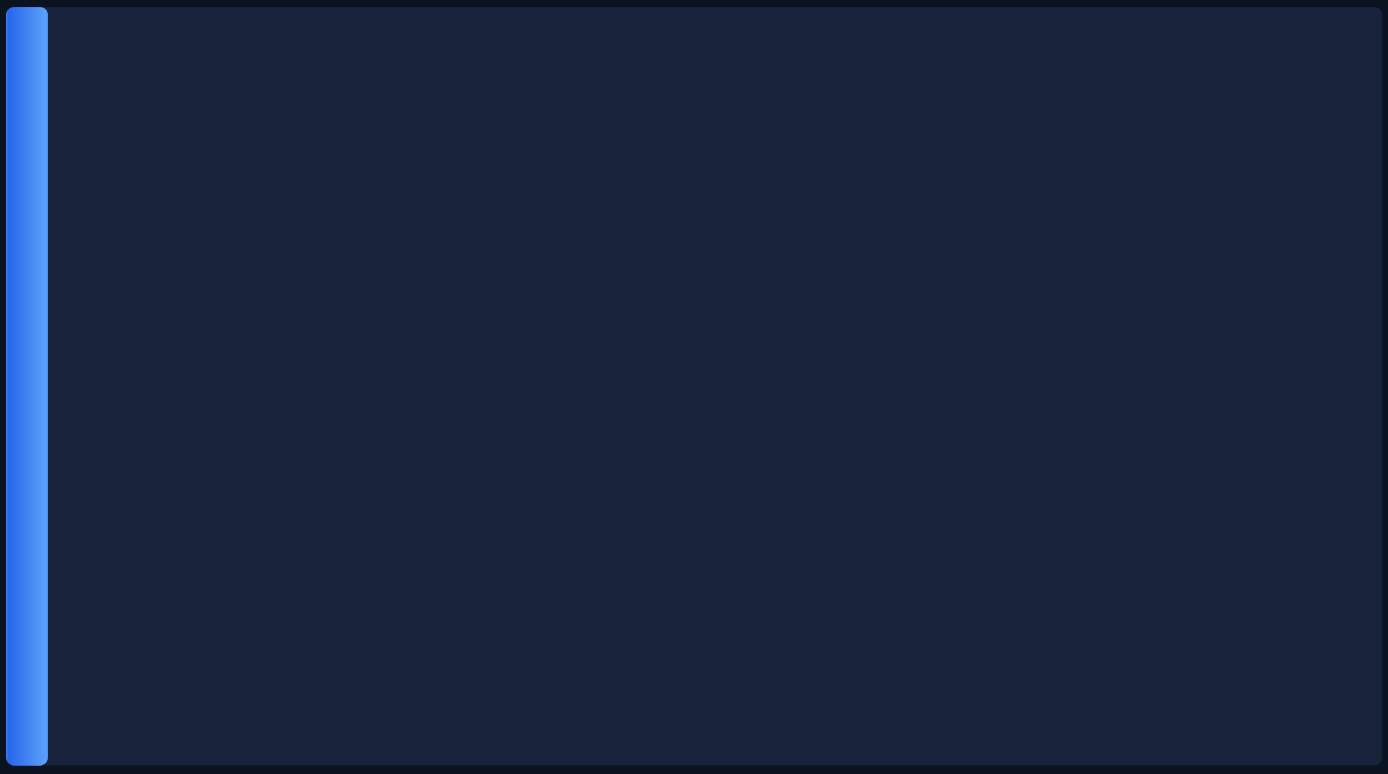
12	319	261	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

09 RansomLook

github.com/RansomLook/RansomLook

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 676	GITHUB STARS
117	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2022	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Yet another Ransomware gang tracker"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open ransomware-group leak-site tracker with historical victim data (see also the live stats at ransomware.live).

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTI analysts tracking ransomware leak sites; the free watchtower the commercial feeds also scrape.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



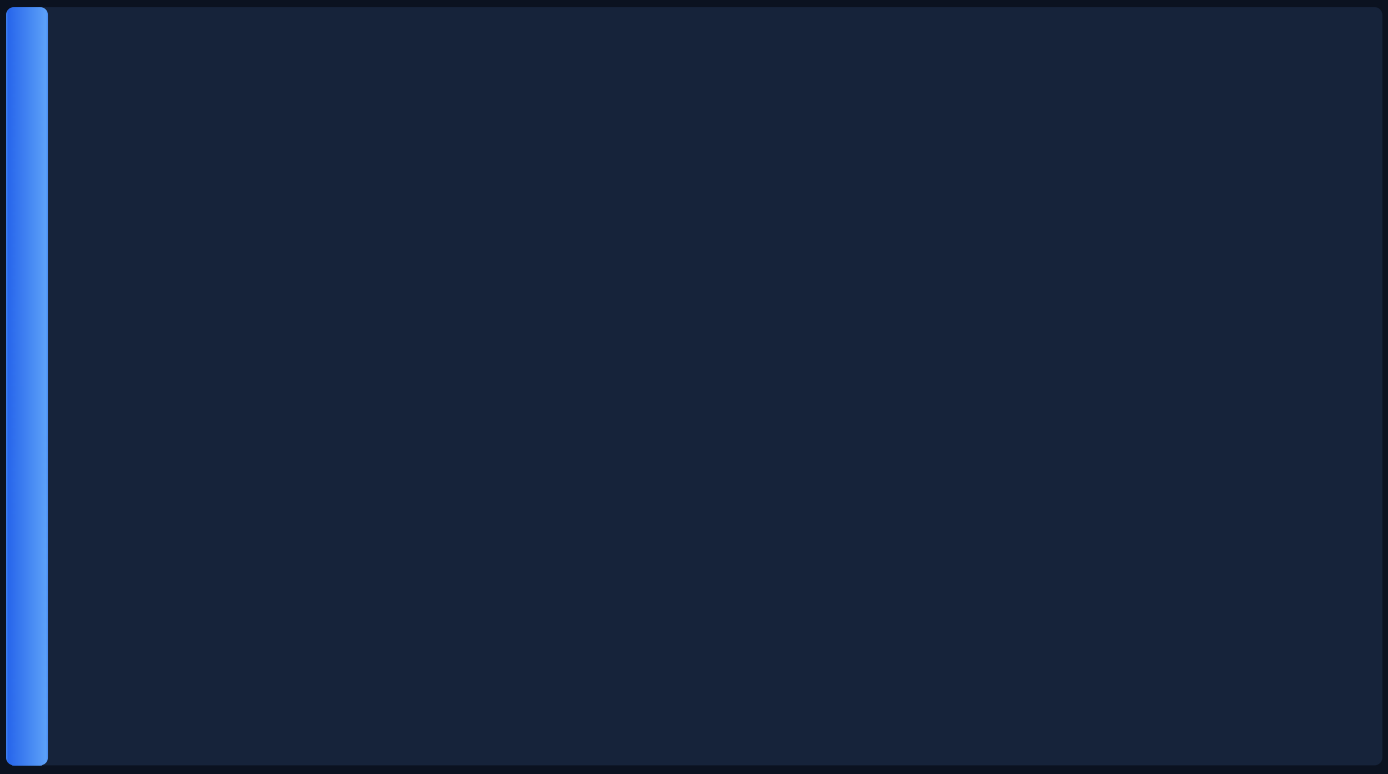
4	117	8	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

10 http-detection-agent

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/ai-blueteam/http-detection-agent

star weight vs realm #1



★ 0	GITHUB STARS
0	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2026	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Capability-aware HTTP attack detection: Rust CLI, local MCP companion, and portable Codex/Claude Code skills."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

traffic anomaly detection for the blue team: labels HTTP datasets without shipping them off-box.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by recon pipelines fingerprinting web servers at scale; a focused open utility for asset inventories.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



0	0	1	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

11 Emerging Threats Open

http://doc.emergingthreats.net/bin/view/Main/EmergingFAQ

WEB / STANDALONE

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Emerging Threats Open"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the open Suricata/Snort rule feed from Proofpoint; thousands of community-maintained detection rules.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by Suricata and Snort defenders everywhere; the free ruleset that the commercial ET Pro subscription extends. (free feed)

12 Malpedia

malpedia.caad.fkie.fraunhofer.de

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Malpedia"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

curated malware encyclopedia: families, actors, papers and sample references for researchers.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by malware researchers as the reference index of families and papers; the free, vendor-neutral encyclopedia.

13 MITRE ATT&CK

attack.mitre.org

WEB / STANDALONE



—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"MITRE ATT&CK"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the adversary tactics & techniques knowledge base that the entire industry maps detections and emulations against.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by red teams, defenders and vendors as the shared language of adversary behavior; the free framework the whole industry maps to.

14 NetworkMiner

www.netresec.com/?page=NetworkMiner

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"NetworkMiner"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

passive network-forensics analyzer: extracts files, credentials and sessions from recorded traffic without touching the live network.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by DFIR analysts for passive network forensics and artifact extraction; the free alternative to commercial network-forensics suites. (free, proprietary)

15 vx-underground

vx-underground.org

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"vx-underground"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the malware corpus and INT report archive; free, massive and respected across the research community.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by malware researchers studying live collections; the free sample and paper archive with no commercial gate. (free service)

16 ZDI advisories

www.zerodayinitiative.com/advisories/published/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"ZDI advisories"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

published zero-day advisories from the Zero Day Initiative; the disclosure record for enterprise-software flaws.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by patch-priority teams tracking pre-disclosure zero-days; the free advisory stream competing with vendor feeds. (free service)

04 Realm Directory

16 curated entries · A–Z

Emerging Threats Open
firehol/blocklist-ipsets
http-detection-agent
IntelMQ
IntelOwl
Malpedia
MISP
MITRE ATT&CK
NetworkMiner
OpenCTI
RansomLook
SpiderFoot
Uncover
vx-underground
Yeti
ZDI advisories